

SECURITY WATCH

CryptoMining in MikroTik Routers

There has been a surge of surreptitious crypto-mining by exploiting a vulnerability in MikroTik Routers. These routers are among the most commonly used in the world, and the vulnerability affects users with MikroTik routers, as well as people accessing websites served by MikroTik routers. The vulnerability used by the exploit was patched in April 2018 by MikroTik, but a number of system administrators have not upgraded the firmware. As a result, over 200,000 MikroTik computers are said to be infected.

Whenever a user visits a web page, a CoinHive script is injected. Then, the system resources of the user is diverted to mining the cryptocurrency. It is unknown how the hackers are doing this, but it does require a deep understanding of the router architecture. The security patches for the router are at <https://dgit.in/mtpatch>.

MOBILE WATCH

Palm Companion

Palm is launching a companion Android device soon, which is a secondary touch-screen for your smartphone. The screen is about the size of a credit card. The phone is designed to keep you connected, but not entirely consumed, through a unique mode called Life Mode. The device syncs with your primary phone, and is equipped with a 12 MP camera.

We are not really sure what the value proposition here is. However, it is true that there are not very many powerful and capable small phones available in the market today, so those who do prefer small phones are left hanging. A companion phone may just be the device to cater to those who prefer smaller screens.



APP WATCH

Run An Empire



If you like running games, and real time strategy games, then Run an Empire is the perfect app for you. It has all the elements of a tabletop or virtual base building game. You collect coins, start off with huts, and go up to building castles. To earn the currency to start building, you need to run around your territory. Additional runs along the same path or territory, reinforces your claim

of the area. The entire world is divided into hexes, or cells that you can capture. The more runs you take along the same path, the more difficult it gets for other runners to capture the territory enclosed. All the other runners in the area are on the same map, so they can wrestle control of bits of your territory also. You can go into skirmishing runs and then capture the territory of other runners nearby. Your “civilisation” can then be upgraded through various levels of technological progress, from the dawn age, to the me-



dieval age, to the space age. You can also build a castle, plonk your flag on it, and even design your own coat of arms with a motto.

If you have a smart-watch that supports Strava, then you do not need to take your phone along for the run to play the game. The app can be configured to sync with Strava. The developers intend to support more fitness trackers in the future. The app can tell if you are using a vehicle, and these “runs” will not be counted. The app is free on Android and iOS, after a successful Kickstarter.

Cinemagraph Pro



Cinemagraphs are photos with a portion of it having looped motion. These stunning looping animations can be created easily with Cinemagraph Pro. The app is powerful enough to work with imported DSLR clips.

Fraksl



Fraksl is a fun little app that lets you directly manipulate and play with fractals. It is like a digital kaleidoscope, where the movements of your fingers decides the patterns on screen. The interface is a little clunky though.



EpicWin



EpicWin is a todo list app that gamifies your own goals. You can set one-off or periodically repeatable tasks. When you complete them, you get to level up your character, and win loot, exactly like a role playing game.

